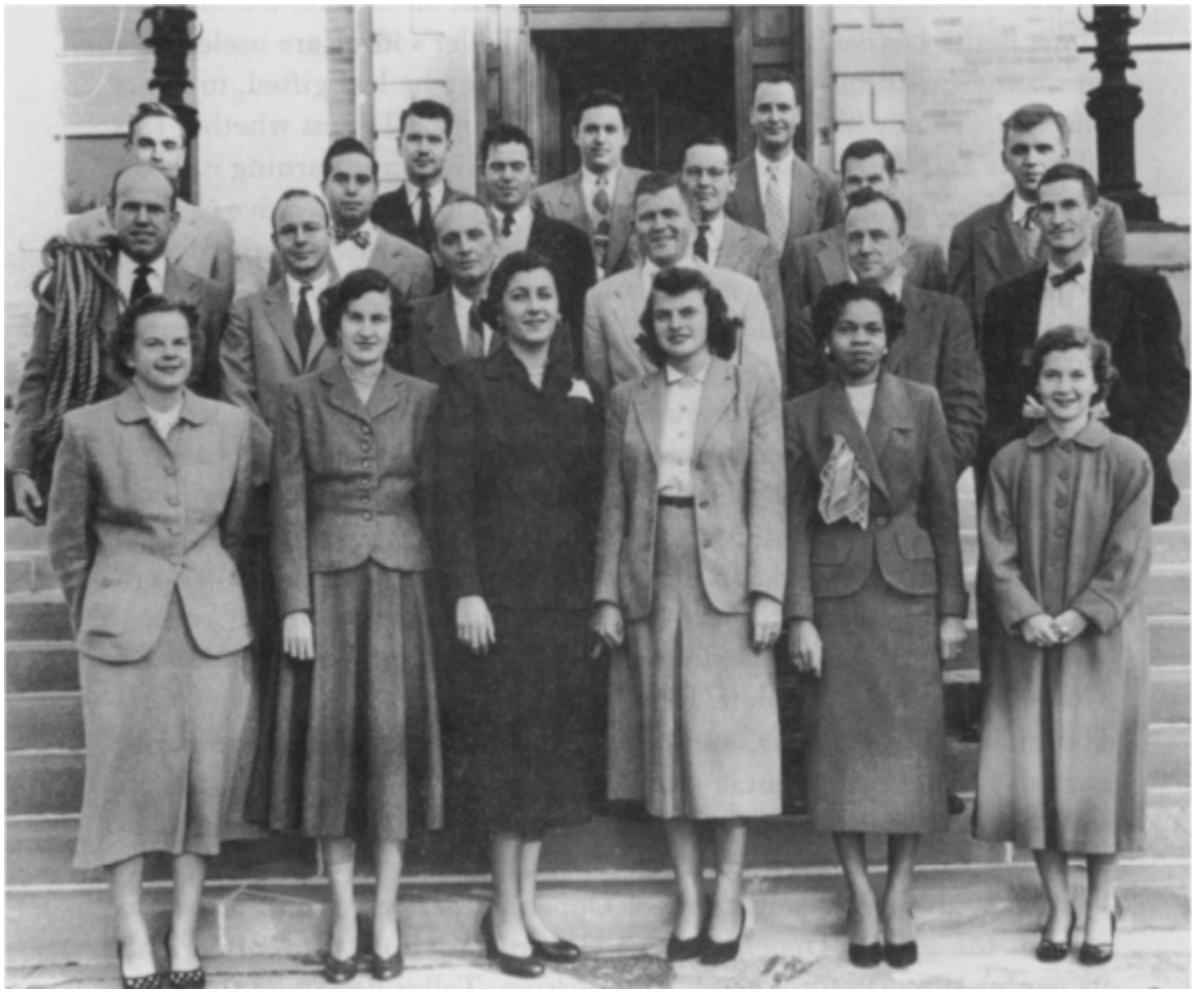
had computed it.] ... The Committee had no option but to conclude that this thing made sense. . . . Our calculation turned Oppie around on the project."



A portion of John Wheeler's hydrogen bomb design team at Princeton University in 1952. ***Front row, left to right:*** **Margaret Fellows, Margaret Murray, Dorothea Reiffel, Audrey Ojala, Christene Shack, Roberta Casey.** ***Second row:*** **Walter Aron, William Clendenin, Solomon Bochner, John Toll, John Wheeler, Kenneth Ford.** ***Third and fourth rows:*** **David Layzer, Lawrence Wilets, David Carter, Edward Frieman, Jay Berger, John Mclntosh, Ralph Pennington, unidentified, Robert Goerss.** [Photo by Howard Schrader; courtesy Lawrence Wilets and John A Wheeler.]

Oppenheimer has described his own reaction: "The program we had in 1949 [the 'prescription for failure'] was a tortured thing that you could well argue did not make a great deal of technical sense. It was therefore possible to argue also that you did not want it even if you could have it. The program in 1952 [the new design based on the Teller –Ulam idea] was technically so sweet that you could not argue about that. The issues became purely the military, the political and the humane problems of what you were going to